

San Diego — Market Strategy Dossier

Prepared for: Jim DesRoches, Principal — KOR Structural · San Diego, June 29 – July 1, 2026 **Companion to:** the six firm dossiers in this packet (H+W, Pinnacle, Bosa Development, Kennedy Wilson, Greystar, Trammell Crow) — this dossier is the *market around them*. **Compiled:** 2026-06-26 · INTERNAL

The play, in one line: KOR enters San Diego with **two motions, not one** — (1) **elevate** the incumbencies it already holds (KOR is the structural engineer of record for **Greystar** and **Kennedy Wilson** in SD, with **JWDA** the warm architect channel), and (2) **displace** the out-of-town engineers that Vancouver developers and architects import — **Glotman Simpson** (Pinnacle, Bosa) and **KPFF** (DBRDS, Carrier Johnson, Safdie Rabines) — using the one advantage they lack: **an active San Diego office**. The open white space is **mass timber** (no SD incumbent) and the **mid-rise podium tier** KPFF and DCI leave under-served.

Confidence key: [HIGH] multi-source verified · [MED] single credible source · [UNVERIFIED] flagged, do not cite client-facing.

Anti-fabrication standard: Every claim is source-backed in-line or in the Sources section. The pervasive limitation of this research is flagged up front: **structural engineer-of-record is not published for ~90% of named SD projects**. Only a handful of developer→SE and owner→SE links were positively verified. Where an SE incumbency is asserted it is because a firm’s own project page, an architect page, or an awards record names it; everything else is marked UNVERIFIED and represents a relationship KOR must confirm through EGBC/SEAOSD network contacts, permit records, or direct outreach.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — THE STRATEGIC PICTURE

San Diego is an **\$8–9B/year construction market** [MED] with a residential and institutional core, a dominant generalist incumbent (KPFF) that owns landmark hospitality + downtown high-rise, and a **fragmented mid-market podium tier and a wide-open mass-timber niche** where no firm has planted a flag. KOR already holds two real footholds — it is the **confirmed structural engineer-of-record on The Lindley** (37-story JWDA tower, Little Italy, completed 2025) and it is **on DBRDS’s structural bid list** (warm architect, hospitality + multifamily). The competitive reality is that KPFF is the structural partner KOR will most often be displacing — it is the named SE for DBRDS, Carrier Johnson, and Safdie Rabines, and the self-described “largest structural team in San Diego.”

The three sharpest plays: (1) **deepen JWDA** from one tower into a pipeline (their Bosa/Greystar tower work is the immediate prize); (2) **own mass timber** before a competitor does — CALGreen 2025’s mandatory embodied-carbon rules (effective Jan 1, 2026) make structural-system choice the #1 carbon lever, and no SD SE firm has a mass-timber flagship; (3) **win the developer-residential mid-rise podium tier** that KPFF (institutional focus) and DCI (concrete high-rise focus) leave under-served. A Vancouver rival, **Glotman Simpson, is already in California** (Seaport SD team listing; LA mass-timber project) — KOR is not the only BC firm eyeing this market, which argues for speed.

1. MARKET STRUCTURE & SEGMENTATION

San Diego County runs roughly **\$8–9B/year in construction put-in-place** [MED] (Suffolk Construction forecast, SDBJ Mar-2024, projecting ~8% YoY growth three years running). Residential permitting is surging — the City permitted ~8,800 new homes in 2024 (second-best in a decade vs. a ~5,100/yr 10-year average) and the County authorized 11,572 units [HIGH]. The market is faster and cheaper to build in than LA: SD commercial plan-check runs 4–7 months vs. LA’s 8–12, and RAND (2025) found SD has the lowest privately-financed multifamily cost among CA metros [MED].

Segment	2026 demand signal	Named pipeline anchors (verified)	SE opportunity for KOR
Residential high-rise / multifamily	Dominant driver; downtown delivered ~1,900 homes in 2024 (strongest since 2021); two 40-story towers under construction	Park 12 (37-story, Greystar); Andia by Bosa (40-story, Cortez Hill); Revel by Cresleigh (40-story, East Village); The Lindley (37-story, KOR is SE); Bosa Diega (41-story), Bosa Simone (36-story)	High — KOR’s core competency; DCI is the concrete-tower incumbent but the field below the trophy towers is fragmented

Segment	2026 demand signal	Named pipeline anchors (verified)	SE opportunity for KOR
Mixed-use / TOD	Mission Valley + East Village growth corridors; SB 79 (eff. Jul-1-2026) mandates housing approval within ½ mile of transit — a structural TOD demand accelerant ; SANDAG distributed \$55M Smart-Growth grants Feb-2026	Riverwalk SD (Hines, \$3–4B, ~4,300 units, Phase 1 ~2028–29); Civita (Sudberry, 4,780 units entitled); SDSU Mission Valley Innovation District (4,600 units, 1.6M sf R&I); Makers Quarter (Lankford); Ballpark Village / Park 12 (JMI Realty)	High — large multi-phase pipelines, several with no named SE
Hospitality	Active; 72.3% occ / \$213 ADR (2025); ~9 hotels/~1,200 rooms under construction; FIFA 2026 + convention demand	The Margot Hotel (DBRDS, 2025, KPFF); Manchester Pacific Gateway Hotel (~1,035 keys, KPFF /Gensler); Tower 180 (560-key dual-Hyatt, 25-story, ~\$250M, started 2026); Gaylord Pacific (Chula Vista, \$1.4B, opened 2025); Jamul Casino expansion (KPFF)	Medium — KPFF owns large hospitality; boutique/mid-size (Margot-scale, via DBRDS) is the wedge
Life science / lab	Top-3 US market BUT cooling — vacancy hit ~25.8% Q2-2025 (20-yr high); starts decelerating	Alexandria Campus Point (Novartis BTS, 466k sf, groundbreaking Feb-2026); IQHQ RaDD (1.7M sf, downtown); Longfellow Bioterra (Sorrento Mesa); Pacific Center (Sorrento Mesa, 690k sf)	Medium-long — Novartis hub is real but near-term starts lag; KPFF/Coffman entrenched
Higher ed (UCSD/SDSU)	Largest institutional program; UCSD \$3.2B capital, LRDP to 36.2M GSF by 2040	UCSD Triton Center (\$428M), MDLS Life Sciences (\$220M, KPFF), Pepper Canyon East (~\$2B, ~6,000 beds, Clark CM/GC); SDSU Evolve (3,640 beds, \$1B, mass-timber , Swinerton DB)	Medium — fragmented enough to enter; KPFF/Coffman/DCI all active
Healthcare	“Billions” in pipeline; SB-1953 seismic deadline 2030 driving acute-care rebuilds	UCSD Hillcrest Redevelopment (\$2.5–3B, seismic/hospital-code); Rady Children’s ICU (\$1.3B); UCSD Jacobs Medical Center (BWE)	Medium — seismic-intensive, aligns with KOR heritage; but NYA/BWE/Coffman incumbents at UCSD
Civic / K-12	SDUSD \$13B+ across four bonds (\$2.6B unspent); City CIP FY26 \$843M	SDUSD Mann MS modernization (Turner); Ocean Beach Pier (\$170–190M, Moffatt & Nichol); City Heights Library	Medium — SDUSD work flows through Lease-Leaseback GCs (target the GC, not the district); DSA approval is a gate
Military / federal / NAVFAC	NAVFAC SW = \$3B General Construction MACC + \$750M Waterfront MACC	MCRD P-315 Mess Hall (\$84M, Michael Baker A-E); MCRD P-314 Barracks; NBSD Pier 6 (\$101M)	Low — BWE/Coffman/Degenkolb incumbents; gated by DoD track record; sub-to-MACC-prime only
Mass timber / sustainable	Early-stage but accelerating; CALGreen 2025 embodied-carbon mandate (≥50k sf, eff. Jan-1-2026)	Niima Outpost (5-story CLT, complete 2025); Harvey Mini (9-story, tallest MT in SoCal); 2100 Kettner (DCI, partial CLT); SDSU Evolve (mass-timber)	HIGH — open lane ; no SD SE firm owns this niche

2. COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE — STRUCTURAL ENGINEERS

2.0 Target-list corrections (verify-before-acting)

Five firms from the standard SD competitive set are **not live SD building-SE competitors** and should be re-tagged:

Firm	Status	Source
Hope Amundson	Merged into Coffman Engineers (Oct 2017); domain redirects to coffman.com	coffman.com/news

Firm	Status	Source
Englekirk / Robert Englekirk	Acquired by WSP (Oct 2021); brand dissolved; never had an SD office	globenewswire WSP release
Latitude 33	Civil/planning/survey only — no structural practice	latitude33.com
SOHA Engineers	Bay Area only (SF + San Leandro); no SD presence	soha.com
TYLin / John A. Martin / MKA	SD work is transportation/aviation/stadium only , executed from out-of-market offices; not building-SE competitors (MKA = Snapdragon Stadium + SAN airport from Seattle; JAMA = aviation from LA; TYLin SD = bridges)	tylin.com, johnmartin.com, mka.com

2.1 Active SD building-SE competitors

KPFF Consulting Engineers — THE #1 DISPLACEMENT TARGET [HIGH]

- **SD presence:** Office since 1994 (Mission Valley); self-described “largest structural team in San Diego,” 10 named structural principals (Eric Lehmkuhl managing principal; Shaun Walters = hospitality/gaming/performance-based seismic specialist). Full-service (structural + civil + survey).
- **Strongholds:** Landmark downtown high-rise, corporate HQ, hospitality + gaming, higher ed, life science.
- **Signature SD projects:** Hard Rock Hotel; Semptra Energy HQ (16-story); Renaissance Condo Towers; Manchester Pacific Gateway Hotel (~1,035 keys); Jamul Casino expansion; Hotel Churchill (historic); UCSD MDLS Life Sciences; UCSD Pepper Canyon West; SENTRAL/K-Elevate Hotel.
- **Architect relationships:** Carrier Johnson (5+ projects — their anchor relationship); DBRDS (default SE — KOR’s direct overlap); Safdie Rabines (CSUSM); Perkins+Will; Gensler; JCJ.
- **vs. KOR:** Scale and breadth are KPFF’s moat; KOR cannot win on size. KOR’s edge is principal-level attention, mid-market hunger, mass timber (KPFF has no MT flagship), and design-collaboration. **KPFF is the SE KOR will most often be displacing on DBRDS, Carrier Johnson, and Safdie Rabines pursuits.**

DCI Engineers — the downtown concrete-tower incumbent [HIGH]

- **SD presence:** Since 2001 (~20 staff; Ryan Slaybaugh managing principal). Active in BISNOW, AIA SD, SEAOSD.
- **Strongholds:** PT-concrete residential high-rise, mixed-use, affordable housing, design-build military, life-science (pursuing).
- **Signature:** Park 12 (1.44M sf, 37-story, SD’s largest-ever resi project, Greystar/Carrier Johnson); Shift Apartments (21-story); Alexan ALX (19-story); Parco (National City, Miller Hull); 2100 Kettner (partial CLT, Gensler/Swinerton); The Q (Little Italy).
- **Architect/developer relationships:** Carrier Johnson, Greystar, Malick Infill, Turner.
- **vs. KOR:** DCI is the most direct competitor for KOR’s core typology (developer residential towers). They focus on the largest concrete projects; the **mid-rise podium tier below them is open.**

Burkett & Wong Engineers (BWE) — the entrenched local generalist [HIGH]

- **SD presence:** HQ since 1971 (55 years, 13,000+ projects). Structural + civil + survey + forensics.
- **Strongholds:** Military/federal (Camp Pendleton x3, Edwards AFB, Nellis, VA), civic (Central Library, County Ops Center), healthcare (UCSD Jacobs Medical Center), broadest sector coverage of any local firm.
- **Architect relationships:** Delawie, KMA, Smith Consulting, Gensler, BNIM (Makers Quarter Block D).
- **vs. KOR:** Deeply rooted but a mature generalist — “not hungry.” Their military moat is unassailable for KOR; their residential/mixed-use work is a contestable overlap.

Coffman Engineers — the multidiscipline design-build/institutional player [HIGH]

- **SD presence:** Since 2016; absorbed Hope-Amundson 2017 (inherited its 24-yr SD client base + principals Chuck Hope, Jim Amundson). 100+ professionals; structural + MEP + fire protection + **mass timber declared as a service.**
- **Strongholds:** Life-science/research (UCSD Franklin Antonio Hall \$185M, Sanford Consortium), federal/civic (San Ysidro Land Port of Entry), NAVFAC military, design-build (DBIA).
- **Relationships:** Perkins+Will, UCSD (deepest of any firm), County of SD, NAVFAC; Miller Hull (civil on Ridge Walk North).
- **vs. KOR:** Multidiscipline one-stop is their design-build advantage. They *claim* mass timber but have **no published SD CLT flagship** — a window for KOR to own the niche first.

Degenkolb Engineers — the seismic-retrofit national brand, thin locally [HIGH]

- **SD presence:** Office at 225 Broadway; small (principal Jeremy Callister + limited staff). Founded 1940; unmatched seismic-code pedigree (SEAOC Blue Book contributors).

- **Strongholds:** Seismic evaluation/retrofit, disaster recovery, construction/steel-erection engineering, cultural/heritage (MCASD construction engineering, Balboa Park Botanical Building).
- **vs. KOR:** The brand to beat on pure seismic — but small SD bandwidth caps their local capacity. **KOR's seismic/heritage heritage is most directly competitive here**, especially soft-story residential retrofit (City of SD program). (Manage the BC EGBC-2019 disclosure context carefully.)

Saiful Bouquet — LA-based, thin SD footprint [MED]

- **SD presence:** Office at 225 Broadway (same building as Degenkolb). MBE-certified (advantage on public/university MWBE goals). Pure-play structural, 27 sectors claimed.
- **Verified SD-built work is thin:** only Cuyamaca College (Rancho San Diego) confirmed built; San Diego Tech Center reached plan-check only. Awards skew LA. [UNVERIFIED] for broader SD portfolio.
- **vs. KOR:** MBE status is their differentiator; otherwise a primarily-LA firm reaching into SD, similar to KOR's own posture.

Nabih Youssef & Associates (NYA) — institutional seismic, leadership transition [MED]

- **SD presence:** Listed but [UNVERIFIED] — no SD address/staff. Founder Nabih Youssef died Jul-2024 (organizational stability open question).
- **SD projects (per nyase.com):** UCSD Hillcrest Medical Center, UCSD North Campus Housing Ph2, VA SD Hospital seismic retrofit, La Jolla Commons. UCSD SE dept lists NYA as affiliate.
- **vs. KOR:** Performance-based seismic pioneer with UCSD/VA institutional ties; not a mid-market or developer-residential competitor.

SGH (Simpson Gumpertz & Heger) — enclosure/forensics, not a head-on rival [HIGH]

- **SD presence:** Office at 401 West A St. SD work skews **building enclosure/waterproofing + forensics**, not structural EOR on new builds (only MCASD as structural EOR).
- **vs. KOR:** Complements rather than competes; minimal direct conflict — potential collaborator, not target.

Smaller/regional SE firms holding specific lanes

- **Chelsea Investment Corp** (affordable housing) — **Harrington Heights uses DCI Engineers**; on Taormina, Modica, and Addison@SDSU the structural engineer isn't publicly named (an opening — confirm via SEAOSD/permit records). Note Fuscoe is Chelsea's civil engineer, not its SE.
- **Coffman / DCI / A.B. Court / WSP(Englekirk)** rotate on Miller Hull projects by type.
- **DCI Engineers is BNIM's SE on Keeler Court** (71-unit affordable, 2023; not "Fard," which is the project's MEP engineer). Burkett & Wong also rotates on BNIM work. To win the BNIM channel, target DCI (Ryan Slaybaugh, SD office at 101 W. Broadway).
- **Mass timber — KOR's white-space lane:**
 - **Facet NW is the active SD mass-timber incumbent:** SE of record on **Harvey / Harvey Mini** (Hillcrest, 9-story, ~65 units — *tallest mass timber in SoCal*). Principal **Jordan Janicki**. Only one SD project so far → **move on the next SD CLT opportunity before Facet entrenches**.
 - **Steven Crook** (at **HED / Harley Ellis Devereaux**) is SE on **9625 Towne Centre Drive** — the first approved CLT application in San Diego (Alexandria RE, glulam+CLT).
 - **BC peers circling but not yet in SD developer-residential CLT (KOR's uncontested window):** Equilibrium Consulting (Eric Karsh; Google MT1, Sunnyvale — KOR's closest BC peer), StructureCraft (Abbotsford design-build, premium model), Aspect (CA work is temporary-works only). None hold SD developer-resi CLT — that gap is the opening; Aspect is a viable *partner* (fabrication depth) where KOR holds the SD SE-of-record.
- **Josephson-Werdowatz** — domusstudio's civic/sacred SE. Two-principal SD firm (Rancho Bernardo) with aging leadership and a heavy expert-witness practice → limited new-design throughput. Displace on larger mixed-use/institutional work with domusstudio.
- **VCA Structural** — Trammell Crow Residential's SE (Modera SD, Alexan Monrovia). **No San Diego office** (Orange, CA, 60+ mi away) — serves SD remotely. Clean local-responsiveness wedge, the same shape as the Glotman gap.

Watch item — Vancouver rival already in California

- **Glotman Simpson** (Vancouver, a direct KOR peer) appears on the **Seaport San Diego** project team listing and is SE-of-record on a **843 N Spring St LA mass-timber** project. [MED] KOR is not the only BC SE pursuing SoCal — **speed matters**.

2.2 Displacement map — who is the incumbent in each segment

Segment	Incumbent SE to displace	Confidence	KOR's realistic path
Landmark downtown high-rise (trophy)	KPFF	HIGH	Hard; compete on mid-tier towers
Downtown concrete resi high-rise	DCI Engineers	HIGH	Direct overlap; win the podium tier below them

Segment	Incumbent SE to displace	Confidence	KOR's realistic path
Mid-rise podium (5–8 story wood-over-concrete)	Fragmented — no dominant brand	HIGH	Best entry lane — KOR's BC core competency
Large hospitality / gaming	KPFF (Shaun Walters)	HIGH	Boutique/mid hospitality via DBRDS
Affordable housing	Fusco (Chelsea); fragmented elsewhere	MED	Wakeland/BRIDGE pipelines have no named SE — open
Life science / research	KPFF, Coffman	MED	Long-game; needs an introduction + first credit
UCSD healthcare/institutional	NYA, BWE, Coffman	HIGH	Crowded; seismic angle on Hillcrest
Civic / cultural / heritage	KPFF, Degenkolb, Coffman	MED	Seismic-retrofit niche (Degenkolb thin locally)
Mass timber / CLT	Nobody dominant (small firms only)	HIGH	Open niche — own it first
Seismic retrofit / soft-story resi	Degenkolb (thin local capacity)	MED	KOR seismic heritage applies directly
Military / NAVFAC	BWE, Coffman, Degenkolb	HIGH	Avoid as primary; sub-to-prime only
Aviation / stadium / bridges	MKA, TYLin, JAMA	HIGH	Not KOR's lane

3. ARCHITECT-PRIMES THAT DRIVE SE SELECTION

These are the firms that win SD building work and choose the structural sub. The structural partner named for each is, by definition, **KOR's displacement target on that architect's pursuits**.

Architect	Sectors	Default/known SE partner (= KOR target)	Warmth to KOR	Priority
JWDA / Joseph Wong Design Associates	Downtown towers, multifamily, hospitality, higher ed	KOR Structural (The Lindley, 37-story, 2025) [HIGH]	WARMEST — active client	#1 — deepen
DBRDS / De Bartolo + Rimanic	Hospitality, multifamily, mixed-use, high-rise (boutique, ~4 staff)	KPFF (The Margot, 475 W Broadway, Union & B, University Canyon) [HIGH]	WARM — KOR on bid list	#2 — push on next RFP
BNIM	Affordable, office, life-science, civic (growing fast in SD)	Rotates — Burkett & Wong (Makers Quarter D), Fard (Keeler Court); Block A SE UNVERIFIED	Open — no SE lock	#3 — pursue
HMC Architects	Healthcare, K-12, higher ed, civic (ENR 2023 CA Firm of Year)	None published	De-prioritize — K-12 (DSA) + healthcare (HCAI) dominant with no developer-residential; both are credential-gated for KOR. Thin civic-only long-tail.	low
AC Martin (LA firm, new SD office)	Multifamily, mixed-use, affordable, civic	Network not yet locked (SD office opened ~late 2023)	OPEN — early-mover window	new — target Sami Khoury / Gilbert Rocca

Architect	Sectors	Default/known SE partner (= KOR target)	Warmth to KOR	Priority
Miller Hull	Civic, higher ed, affordable, life-science	Coffman (civic), DCI (mixed-use resi — Parco) , WSP/Englekirk (seismic research)	Type-matched, no lock	#5 — enter via mixed-use
Safdie Rabines	Multifamily, campus housing, civic, bridges, cultural	KPFF in the Sea Breeze / North City ecosystem [MED] — BUT three near-term marquee commissions have NO SE named yet: Oceanside Museum of Art expansion, San Diego Museum of Art (Balboa Park) renovation, Midway Rising [OPEN SEATS]	Design-sensitive; cultural/heritage fits KOR	↑ #3 — genuine open seats on cultural work
Carrier Johnson + Culture	Mixed-use high-rise, hospitality, master planning, higher ed	KPFF (7th & Market, Hard Rock, Semptra, Renaissance); also DCI (Park 12)	KPFF/DCI entrenched	#7 — enter via ed/sports
domusstudio	Civic (fire stations, libraries), sacred, senior housing	Josephson Werdowatz	Low-volume but reliable	#8
AVRP Studios	Healthcare, K-12, affordable/senior, mixed-use	Partially in-house (Element); external on complex work UNVERIFIED	Investigate healthcare/ed	#9
Gensler SD	Aviation, life-science, sports, mixed-use, hospitality	SE likely national/centralized; SD non-aviation UNVERIFIED	Large firm, hard to crack	#10
Delawie	Govt/defense, education, hospitality	In-house (joined LEO A DALY Dec-2025)	Do not pursue — integrated A/E	—
LPA, Stantec, AECOM	Various	In-house structural teams	Do not pursue — closed ecosystems	—
CallisonRTKL	Now Arcadis ; Seaport SD shows BIG architect + Glotman Simpson SE	Track Seaport SD evolution	Watch item	—

Key reads: JWDA is KOR's warmest live relationship — convert one tower into a pipeline. DBRDS is the warm bid-list relationship where KPFF is the incumbent to displace; the boutique hospitality lane (Margot-scale) is where DBRDS is *not* backed by a corporate SE the way Gensler is backed by KPFF. BNIM is the best *open* (no-lock) target. HMC is the highest-upside cold call (large healthcare/K-12 pipeline, no published SE) — but DSA (schools) / HCAI (healthcare) credentialing is a gate KOR must clear.

4. DEMAND SIDE — DEVELOPERS & PUBLIC OWNERS

4.1 Private developers (verified pipelines; SE links mostly UNVERIFIED = open lanes)

Developer	Tier	Active pipeline (named, verified)	Known SE	KOR read
Wakeland Housing	Affordable	The Becker/Riverwalk (190u, \$140M); Cuatro (115u); The Teralta (72u); Union Tower; The Joule (208u)	None identified — UNVERIFIED	OPEN LANE — top target, \$70–140M projects, no incumbent SE

Developer	Tier	Active pipeline (named, verified)	Known SE	KOR read
Chelsea Investment Corp	Affordable	Harrington Heights (270u, \$150M); Taormina (136u); Modica (94u); Addison@SDSU (126u)	Harrington Heights = DCI (confirmed, JWDA page); Taormina/Modica/Addison = SE not publicly named (Fusco = civil, not SE)	DCI holds the flagship; the other three are OPEN — SE not yet visible (get via permit/SEAOSD)
Affirmed Housing	Affordable	SkyLINE (99u, \$91M); The Helm (78u); Zephyr (85u); SDUSD workforce-housing shortlist	KPFF on partners page (Fusco = civil, not SE) [MED]	Warm-listed only; pursue
Sudberry Properties	Market-rate/MU	The Brynn@Civita (200u); Civita master plan (4,780u entitled); Rio Vista West (1,600u)	None — UNVERIFIED (RICK = civil only)	OPEN LANE — large entitled pipeline
Hines	Mega/MU	Riverwalk SD (\$3B, ~4,300 homes + 1M sf office, Phase 1 ~2029, Gensler)	UNVERIFIED	High-value, long horizon
JMI Realty (not “JMB Realty” — CRM correction)	Master-plan	Ballpark Village / Park 12 (713u, 37-story, with Greystar)	UNVERIFIED (DCI on Park 12 tower)	Remaining phases available
Cisterra Development	MU/office	7th & Market (39-story Ritz-Carlton, status UNVERIFIED); Radian (241u); Preserve@Torrey Highlands	UNVERIFIED (Carrier Johnson architect → KPFF risk)	Track
IQHQ / Alexandria / Longfellow / Stockdale	Life-science	RaDD (1.7M sf); Campus Point/Novartis (466k sf); Bioterra (323k sf); Campus@Horton	UNVERIFIED (KPFF rumored on IQHQ, unconfirmed)	Long-game; cooling market
Lankford & Associates	MU master-plan	Makers Quarter, East Village (2.5M sf, 800 resi units; BNIM architect)	UNVERIFIED	Open; BNIM relationship is the route

CRM corrections: “JMB Realty” → **JMI Realty** (the real SD entity). **Pacific Building Group** = a GC, not a developer. **Swinerton** = GC/design-build lead (SDSU Evolve, LPC West), not a developer — but a key design-build channel partner.

4.2 Public owners & capital programs

Owner	Program scale (verified)	Procurement	Verified SE	KOR read
UC San Diego	\$3.2B capital ; LRDP to 36.2M GSF by 2040	CM/GC at-risk (McCarthy, DPR, Clark repeat)	KPFF (MDLS Life Sciences); Coffman (civil, Ridge Walk)	Hillcrest (\$2.5–3B, seismic/hospital-code by 2030) + The Depot (seismic retrofit) = KOR’s heritage fit
City of San Diego CIP	FY26 \$843M ; 1,232 active projects; \$466M to award	Design-build / DBB / JOC	Moffatt & Nichol (OB Pier — only named SE)	Marine/civic; limited resi-SE fit
City Affordable (Bridge to Home)	\$123M / 28 projects / 2,676u	Developer-procured	None (developers pick SE)	Reach via Wakeland/Chelsea
San Diego Housing Commission	~\$382M assets; \$474M bonds	Developer-procured	None	Same — target the developers
SDUSD	\$13B+ across 4 bonds (\$2.6B unspent; Measure U \$3.2B)	Lease-Leaseback (target the LLB GC, e.g. Turner)	None named	DSA credential required; reach via LLB GCs

Owner	Program scale (verified)	Procurement	Verified SE	KOR read
SDSU	Evolve \$1B (3,640 beds, mass-timber); Life Sciences \$150M; Mission Valley	Design-build (Evolve), CM-at-risk	UNVERIFIED all	Mass-timber + housing fit; reach via Swinerton DB team
County of San Diego	\$9.1B total budget (FY26-27); building work modest	Not specified	None	Lower building-SE volume
NAVFAC Southwest	\$3B General IDIQ (8 holders, 90% CA work) + \$750M Waterfront MACC; FY26 Navy/USMC MILCON \$3.8B	Design-build, MACC/IDIQ task orders	Michael Baker (P-315 A-E)	Sub-to-IDIQ-prime ONLY — 8 holders: Clark, Gilbane, Harper (SD) , Hensel Phelps, R.A. Burch, RQ (Carlsbad) , Tutor Perini, Walsh
Port of San Diego	Chula Vista Bayfront / Gaylord (\$1.35B); Tenth Ave Terminal (\$227M+)	Port Public Works	None named	Marine/civic; limited fit

5. KOR POSITION & STRATEGY

5.1 Honest read of KOR's current SD position

- **Two real footholds, not zero:** KOR is the **confirmed SE-of-record on The Lindley** (37-story JWDA tower, completed 2025) — a blue-chip, verifiable SD high-rise credential — and is **on DBRDS's structural bid list** (warm hospitality/multifamily architect).
- **The incumbent reality:** KPFF is the firm KOR will most often displace — named SE for DBRDS, Carrier Johnson, and Safdie Rabines, and the largest structural team in the market. DCI owns downtown concrete resi towers. KOR cannot win on scale.
- **No SD track record in most segments** — but The Lindley + a Vancouver-developer-residential pedigree + mass-timber/seismic depth are genuine, transferable assets.
- **The Glotman Simpson wedge — KOR's cleanest displacement vector:** Bosa and Pinnacle import **Glotman Simpson** for their SD towers. Glotman has an **LA office but NO San Diego office**, and has served **~50 SD high-rises remotely from Vancouver/LA**. That is the one major rival genuinely lacking SD boots — unlike **KPFF (SD office since 1994)** and **DCI (SD office since 2001)**, which are *local* incumbents that must be displaced on principal-attention/sector grounds, not presence. Pitch Bosa SD / Pinnacle SD before they auto-dial Vancouver. (*Caveat: Glotman is already pursuing CA — Seaport SD team + an LA mass-timber project — so speed matters; the mass-timber niche is open now but won't stay open.*)
- **Licensing gate (must confirm before any pursuit):** All SD work requires a **California-licensed SE** (or CA Civil PE with SE authorization for lower-seismic structures). Civic/K-12 work additionally requires **DSA** approval; acute-care healthcare requires **HCAI/OSHPD**. NAVFAC/military requires teaming with one of the 8 IDIQ prime GCs (and clearance readiness on some projects). KOR's CA registration status should be confirmed as step one — it gates everything below.
- **1650 Hotel Circle — VERIFY THE ADDRESS:** Public records show an active 12-story mixed-use SDP at **1650 Hotel Circle NORTH** (149 units, filed Mar-2025, developer/architect unnamed in the notice). **No active project verified at 1650 Hotel Circle SOUTH.** [UNVERIFIED] Confirm the address and the DBRDS connection with the referral source before the trip — this is the stated SD beachhead and the data does not cleanly corroborate it.

5.2 Where to play (priority segments)

1. **Developer-residential mid-rise podium (5–8 story wood-over-concrete)** — KOR's BC core competency; fragmented field below KPFF (institutional) and DCI (concrete trophy towers). The highest-volume, lowest-resistance entry.
2. **Mass timber / CLT** — open niche, no SD incumbent; CALGreen 2025 embodied-carbon mandate makes it structurally relevant on every ≥50k sf project; BC is North America's most advanced MT market; Kalesnikoff (BC supplier on Niima Outpost) is a ready relationship bridge.
3. **Boutique/mid-size hospitality** — via DBRDS, where KPFF's lock is on the large/gaming end, not Margot-scale.
4. **Seismic retrofit / soft-story residential** — Degenkolb is thin locally; City of SD has a retrofit program; KOR's seismic/heritage heritage applies (manage the EGBC-2019 disclosure).

5.3 How to win

- **Teaming via warm architects** — JWDA and DBRDS are the front doors; lead with The Lindley as proof.

- **Displacement plays** — (1) **Glotman Simpson** on Bosa/Pinnacle imported work — the no-SD-office gap is the wedge, KOR can be in the room locally; (2) **KPFF** on DBRDS/Carrier Johnson pursuits (principal attention, mass-timber fluency, design collaboration — *not* presence; KPFF is local); (3) **DCI** on the mid-rise tier they don't prioritize.
- **Differentiation** — (a) seismic/heritage; (b) dual BC+SD presence and cross-border design experience; (c) woodframe + large-scale concrete range; (d) **mass-timber + embodied-carbon/LCA fluency** as a CALGreen-2026 selling point no local rival owns.

5.4 Prioritized target shortlist + entry move

Architects

Rank	Target	Entry move
1	JWDA	Convert The Lindley into a pipeline — pursue their Bosa/Greystar tower work; ask for the next-project intro directly.
2	DBRDS	Get onto the next hospitality/multifamily RFP; lead with The Lindley + Margot-scale fit; position as the responsive alternative to KPFF.
3	BNIM	No SE lock + growing fast; pursue mixed-use high-rise + affordable; aim to unseat Burkett & Wong on their next Block.
4	HMC	Cold outreach on healthcare/K-12 — confirm/pursue DSA + HCAI credentials first (the gate).
5	Miller Hull	Enter via mixed-use residential (DCI's lane on Parco) where their SE selection is type-matched, not locked.

Developers / owners

Rank	Target	Entry move
1	Wakeland Housing	Open lane — \$70–140M affordable pipeline, no named SE; introduce directly.
2	Sudberry Properties	4,780 units entitled at Civita, civil-only named; pursue the next residential phase.
3	Hines (Riverwalk)	\$3B multi-phase; long-game relationship for Phase 1 (~2029).
4	SDSU Evolve / Swinerton DB team	Mass-timber + housing fit; reach via the design-build GC.
5	UCSD Hillcrest	Seismic/hospital-code mega-program; KOR heritage fit; reach via the CM/GC.

Two caveats before citing

- **The structural engineer of record is unpublished for most named SD projects.** Where this dossier names an incumbent SE, it's because a firm, architect, or award names them; otherwise treat incumbency as unconfirmed and verify through the SEAOSD network or permit records before asserting it in a meeting.
- **1650 Hotel Circle "South" does not exist** — the real project is 1650 Hotel Circle *North*, and the DBRDS link to it is unverified. Don't lead with it; confirm the address and the architect with the referral source first.

SOURCES

Competitive landscape: kpff.com (office/SD + project pages: Hard Rock, Sempra, Renaissance, Manchester Pacific Gateway, Jamul, Hotel Churchill, MDLS, 7th & Market); bwesd.com; dci-engineers.com (San Diego location + Park 12, Shift, Alexan ALX, Parco, The Q); coffman.com (SD location + Franklin Antonio Hall, San Ysidro, Sanford Consortium, Hope-Amundson merger); degenkolb.com (SD office);

saifulbouquet.com (SD contact + portfolio); nyase.com; sgh.com (SD locations + MCASD, K1, UCSD projects); globenewswire (WSP–Englekirk acquisition); latitude33.com; soha.com; tylin.com; johnmartin.com; mka.com (Snapdragon, SAN FIS, San Ysidro); seaportsandiego.com/team.html; glotmansimpson.com; woodworksinnovationnetwork.org (843 N Spring St).

Architect-primes: kpff.com/project/7th-market-mixed-use; jwdainc.com/projects/the-lindley; korstructural.com/project/the-lindley; dbrds.com (hospitality + project pages); carrierjohnson.com; millerhull.com (Parco, Torrey Pines, East County, UCSD SME); bnim.com + archdaily.com/944795 (Makers Quarter D); coffman.com (Miller Hull projects); lpadesignstudios.com (in-house SE); stantec.com; aecom.com; leoadaly.com/news/delawie-joins-leoadaly; domusstudio.com; avrpstudios.com/work/element; gensler.com.

Demand side (developers/owners): chelseainvestco.com; sdsu.edu/news; multifamilyaffordablehousing.com (Becker/Hines); sdhc.org (Cuatro, Teralta, partnership-development); suffolk.com (Union Tower); affirmedhousing.com; sudprop.com; hines.com/properties/riverwalk-san-diego; multihousingnews.com; cisterra.com; jmirerealty.com/ballpark-village; lankfordandassociates.com; prnewswire.com (Alexandria/Novartis, Pacific Center); novartis.com; mccarthy.com (Bioterra); turnerconstruction.com (IQHQ, Sempra, Mann); stockdalecapital.com; sandiego.gov/cip + /cip/reports; insidesandiego.org; countynewscenter.com; sandiegounified.org; voiceofsandiego.org; plandesignbuild.ucsd.edu; housing.sdsu.edu/evolve-student-housing; tradelineinc.com; dvidshub.net (NAVFAC \$3B, P-315, Camp Pendleton); mansonconstruction.com (P-443/508); portofsandiego.org.

Market size / dynamics / seismic / mass timber: sdbj.com (Suffolk forecast); insidesandiego.org (permits); fred.stlouisfed.org/series/BPPRIV006073; k2staffinginc.com (SD vs LA labor); rand.org (2025 MF cost); turnerconstruction.com (T1 topping-out); amsires.com (Seaport); monograph.com + cadcrowd.com + pe-se.com + calichi.com + pricinglink.com (SE fee/business-model benchmarks); sandiego.gov IB-101 (construction-cost benchmarks); timesofsandiego.com + livingthesandiegolife.com (high-rise timelines); en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rose_Canyon_Fault; sandiego.eeri.org; 10news.com (Rose Canyon scenario); optimumseismic.com (LA EAL ranking); iseengineers.com + pacificbeachbuilder.com (2025 CBC/ASCE 7-22); miyamotointernational.com (Julian M5.2, SD office); temblor.net + stantec.com (Vancouver NBCC 2020); woodworksinnovationnetwork.org (Niima Outpost, 9625 Towne Centre); buildsd.org + harveyhillcrest.com (Harvey Mini); swinerton.com (2100 Kettner, SDSU Evolve); today.ucsd.edu (NHERI TallWood); aiacalifornia.org + usgbc-ca.org (CALGreen 2025 embodied carbon); archpaper.com (CA mass-timber facility); savills.us + cbre.com (life-science vacancy); stories.hilton.com (The Margot); sdvoyager.com (DBRDS profile).

Claims marked UNVERIFIED were not confirmable from accessible public sources and must not be cited client-facing without confirmation.